

CORRECTION

Correction to “Desert and redistribution: Justice as a remedy for, and cause of, economic inequality”

Copyright

© 2026 Policy Studies Organization.

License

All rights reserved, including rights for text and data mining and training of artificial intelligence technologies or similar technologies.

Bower-Bir, J.S. (2022) Desert and Redistribution: Justice as a Remedy for, and Cause of, Economic Inequality. *Policy Studies Journal*, 50, 757–795. <https://doi.org/10.1111/psj.12439>

Every model in the paper was re-estimated from the original survey data, independently in R and in Python, against the original 2014 Stata code. Every coefficient, standard error, sample size, R^2 , and adjusted R^2 in Tables 1, C1, C2, and D1 reproduces exactly, as does every row of Table A1. The cells listed below are the only ones that did not reproduce, which is how they were found. All are transcription slips between a correct result and the printed page, and all originate in the submitted LaTeX manuscript, not in typesetting. None touches an estimate, a model, a sample, or a conclusion.

Table 1

Row	Column	Published	Correct
Definition	Y_{gov} , Model 3	0.518***	−0.518***
Rich deserve (SE)	Y_{gov} , Model 3	(1.056)	(0.056)
Non-White (SE)	$Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$, Model 1	(0.012)	(0.031)
Agency	$Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$, Model 1	−0.133***	−0.133**

Correction summary. *Definition:* the minus sign was dropped; Section 6.3 already states the correct result in words (“definition of desert always has a negative and statistically significant influence on Y_{gov} ”). As printed, it was the only sign reversal in an otherwise uniformly negative row, so the corrected value restores the pattern the text describes. *Rich deserve SE:* as printed, −0.366 over an SE of 1.056 gives $t = 0.35$, which cannot carry the three stars shown; the correct SE gives $t = 6.5$, consistent with the significance. *Non-White SE:* a decimal slip; the coefficient is non-significant either way. *Agency:* $t = -2.52$, $p = 0.012$, significant at 5% rather than 1%; the coefficient stays negative and significant, only the star count changes.

Appendix C, Table C1

Row	Column	Published	Correct
Married	$Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$, Model B	0.320	0.032



- 1 Proof Initiated
7/28/2026
- 2 Corresponding Author
Due date: 7/30/2026
Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3 Proof Collator
- 4 Completed

Format

Undo

Redo

Insert

Citation

Comment

View

Zoom

Author Proof

Correction summary. Married is non-significant either way; the two Education cells are decimal slips in the standard error that leave every significance verdict unchanged.

Appendix C, Table C2

Row	Column	Published	Correct
Income	Y_{gov} , Model E	0.136***	-0.136***
N	$Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$, Model A	963	992

Correction summary. *Income*: the minus sign was dropped; the magnitude and significance are unchanged and the corrected sign matches the negative income relationship throughout the paper. *N*: a label, not an estimate. Models containing *Definition* have $N = 963$, because 29 respondents have no value for that variable; models without it have $N = 992$. Model A ($Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$) carries no *Definition*, so its N is 992.

Appendix D, Table D1 ($Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$, Model 3)

Six coefficients in the desert block were printed against the wrong row labels. The Stata output listed the block in one order; the table interleaved it in another; the column was transcribed downward against the interleaved labels. The correct assignment:

Printed row label	Published value	Belongs to
Rich deserve	0.833	Rich deserve, corrected to 0.883 (also a digit slip)
Definition × Rich deserve	-0.653	Avg. deserve
Avg. deserve	-0.922	Poor deserve
Definition × Avg. deserve	-1.300	Definition × Rich deserve
Poor deserve	0.662	Definition × Avg. deserve
Definition × Poor deserve	0.860	correct row; its SE (0.926) was a duplication of the row above and should read (0.900)

Correction summary. None of these six coefficients is statistically significant, so the conclusion drawn in Section D.2, that the interaction is not supported, is unchanged. The Y_{gov} columns of Table D1 were printed correctly and are unchanged.

Every item above is a slip of transcription between a correct analytical result and the printed page. The paper's findings, its argument, and its interpretation are unaffected. A public replication package (the survey



- 1

Proof Initiated

7/28/2026
- 2

Corresponding Author

Due date: 7/30/2026

Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3

Proof Collator
- 4

Completed

request.

Author Proof

Corrected tables

Every cell below was regenerated from the original survey data (*N* reflects listwise deletion on the model's variables). These tables are correct in every cell and are offered as drop-in replacements. Any difference in adjusted *R*² of ≤ 0.0003 reflects the software's degrees-of-freedom convention for absorbed state fixed effects and is not a correction. The Constant is the grand-mean (*areg*) intercept; because Stata's *areg* uses a slightly different degrees-of-freedom convention for the intercept's significance test, the Constant's significance marker may differ from the published table by one level in borderline cases; this too is not a correction.

TABLE 1.

Variable	<i>Y</i> _{gov} Model 1	<i>Y</i> _{gov} Model 2	<i>Y</i> _{gov} Model 3	<i>Y</i> _{tax} Model 1	<i>Y</i> _{tax} Model 2	<i>Y</i> _{tax} Model 3
Definition	– 0.382***	– 0.498***	– 0.518***	0.139	0.067	0.067
	(0.148)	(0.126)	(0.131)	(0.140)	(0.128)	(0.128)
Agency	– 0.215***			–0.133**		
	(0.051)			(0.053)		
Justice		– 0.403***			– 0.258***	
		(0.048)			(0.056)	
Rich deserve			– 0.366***			– 0.366***
			(0.056)			(0.056)
Avg. deserve			– 0.126***			– 0.126***
						(0.056)

TABLE C1. *Y*_{gov_fix_gap}.

Variable	gov Model A	gov Model B	gov Model C	gov Model D	gov Model E
Definition		– 0.469***			
		(0.143)			
Agency			– 0.221***		
			(0.050)		
Justice				– 0.375***	
				(0.048)	
Rich deserve					– 0.338***
					(0.055)



- 1

Proof Initiated
7/28/2026
- 2

Corresponding Author
Due date: 7/30/2026
Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3

Proof Collator
- 4

Completed

TABLE C1. $Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$

Variable	tax Model A	tax Model B	tax Model C	tax Model D	tax Model E
Definition		0.085 (0.137)			
Agency			-0.129** (0.052)		
Justice				-0.285*** (0.053)	
Rich deserve					-0.336*** (0.078)
Avg. deserve					-0.050 (0.054)

TABLE C2. $Y_{\text{gov_fix_gap}}$

Variable	gov Model A	gov Model B	gov Model C	gov Model D	gov Model E
Definition		-0.466*** (0.136)	-0.384*** (0.141)	-0.445*** (0.117)	-0.482*** (0.129)
Agency			-0.202*** (0.052)		
Justice				-0.420*** (0.050)	
Rich deserve					-0.370*** (0.059)
Avg. deserve					-0.132***

TABLE C2. $Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$

Variable	tax Model A	tax Model B	tax Model C	tax Model D	tax Model E
Definition		0.082 (0.135)	0.127 (0.139)	0.094 (0.129)	0.063 (0.132)



- 1 Proof Initiated
7/28/2026
- 2 Corresponding Author
Due date: 7/30/2026
Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3 Proof Collator
- 4 Completed



1 Proof Initiated
7/28/2026

2 Corresponding Author
Due date: 7/30/2026
Start date: 7/28/2026

3 Proof Collator

4 Completed

Variable	tax Model A	Author Proof		tax Model D	tax Model E
		Model B	Model C		
Agency			-0.111**		
			(0.052)		
Justice				- 0.249***	
				(0.058)	
Rich deserve					- 0.289***
					(0.076)

TABLE D1. $Y_{\text{gov_fix_gap}}$

Variable	gov Model 1	gov Model 2	gov Model 3
Definition	0.426	0.214	1.091**
	(0.265)	(0.184)	(0.451)
Agency	0.868***		
	(0.298)		
Def. × Agency	-1.327***		
	(0.358)		
Justice		0.769**	
		(0.312)	
Def. × Justice		-1.430***	
		(0.365)	
Rich deserve			2.514**
			(1.031)

TABLE D1. $Y_{\text{prog_tax}}$

Variable	tax Model 1	tax Model 2	tax Model 3
Definition	0.903***	0.103	0.244
	(0.241)	(0.185)	(0.403)
Agency	0.890***		
	(0.264)		
Def. × Agency	-1.255***		
	(0.320)		
Justice		-0.197	
		(0.250)	
Def. × Justice		-0.074	
		(0.304)	



- 1

Proof Initiated

7/28/2026
- 2

Corresponding Author

Due date: 7/30/2026

Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3

Proof Collator
- 4

Completed



- 1

Proof Initiated

7/28/2026
- 2

Corresponding Author

Due date: 7/30/2026

Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3

Proof Collator
- 4

Completed



- 1 **Proof Initiated**
7/28/2026
- 2 **Corresponding Author**
Due date: 7/30/2026
Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3 **Proof Collator**
- 4 **Completed**

Author Proof

We apologize for this error.

--End of Document-----



- 1 **Proof Initiated**
7/28/2026
- 2 **Corresponding Author**
Due date: 7/30/2026
Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3 **Proof Collator**
- 4 **Completed**



- 1

Proof Initiated

7/28/2026
- 2

Corresponding Author

Due date: 7/30/2026

Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3

Proof Collator
- 4

Completed



- 1 **Proof Initiated**
7/28/2026
- 2 **Corresponding Author**
Due date: 7/30/2026
Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3 **Proof Collator**
- 4 **Completed**



- 1

Proof Initiated

7/28/2026
- 2

Corresponding Author

Due date: 7/30/2026

Start date: 7/28/2026
- 3

Proof Collator
- 4

Completed